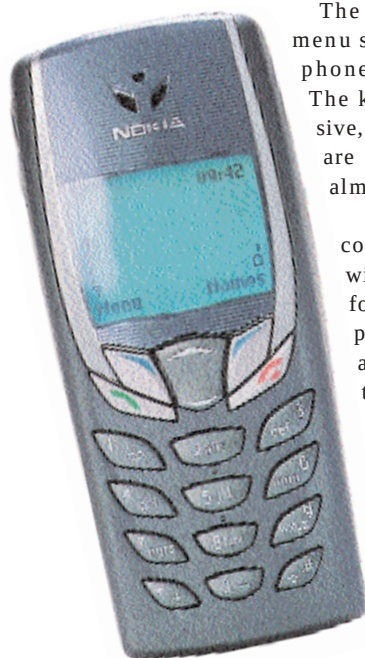


Nokia 6510

Price: Rs 13,599 B+

Not only does the 6510 pack in all the virtues of the 6xxx series, phone but also the best features of all other series, especially the 8xxx series.

The change that comes to immediate notice is the high-resolution screen and the slowly fading in turquoise backlight when activated. Such backlighting is refreshing, especially after using the conventional green, which is widely used for all other Nokia models. The build quality is acceptable, except for a flimsy battery cover.



The 6510 also employs the same menu structure as the rest of the Nokia phones, which is quite simple to use. The keypad buttons are very responsive, though the navigation buttons are bit cramped. Feature-wise it is almost identical to the 8310.

This is the best phone when it comes to calendaring—it comes with a full monthly or weekly view for those with busy schedules. The phone is able to store 500 contacts along with notes, reminders etc. the best feature being the ability to send these notes to other devices or to other phones via SMS and infrared. This is a good way of sharing your information with friends and colleagues. The phone also supports voice-dialling, voice-command and voice-recording, of up to 3 minutes. On the

messaging front, the phone can store up to 150 SMS or 50 picture messages. The overall speed response of text input is also very fast.

In terms of data connectivity, the phone supports both GPRS and HSCSD for faster connections. It also supports WAP 1.2.1 for browsing the Internet, and an IrDA port for data transfer.

The phone comes bundled with four games for your entertainment, and also a mono FM radio that has 10 presets through the keypad that saves scrolling through the entire list of channels. The signal reception and voice clarity were commendable.

If you need a good phone that doubles as a PIM, then 6510 is the phone for you.

Nokia 8250

Price: Rs 10,299 B-

The 8250 is a spruced up version of the trendy 8210. This phone has the best set of clothes in the entire Nokia line up of models. The colour combination, the eye grabbing keypad layout and the exhilarating blue backlight, gives the phone its unique appeal.

The most striking feature is the ergonomic keypad layout. The navigation keys sport a beautiful butterfly shape or the X-theme that not only looks cool but is very practical. The keys are big, raised and provide excellent touch feedback—a boon for SMS junkies. The menu structure is always the same across the Nokia models, with a few additions here and there.



The 8250 incorporates many of the features, such as screensavers and SMS chat from the 3xxx series of phones. The phone book, call registration, etc are similar to other Nokia models. It doesn't come with a full-fledged calendar option, but supports reminders and notes. Furthermore, these notes can be sent via SMS, Infra red and so on.

The 8250 comes bundled with four games, good ring tones, a ring tone composer, picture editor and FM radio. It is not WAP-enabled, which takes away from its appeal. It offers an IrDA port for faster data transfer between your PC and phone.

Overall a fantastic looking phone with all the basic features, but a price that will make you flinch—Rs 10,299.

Nokia 8310

Price: Rs 15,599 B+

The 8310 is a small, compact cell phone that will surely attract the younger generation. Our review unit sported an elegant blue and grey outer shell with alternating colours for the keypad. The use of chrome for menu buttons and the navigation keys give it a retro finish. Nokia has gone a step forward to include a bright white backlight, which further enhances the overall appeal.

The phone does not rule the technology roost, concentrating more on quality rather than a quantity of features. It supports a mammoth 500 address book entries and has a dynamic memory allocation, which lets you push in more numbers if the names occupy less space. The phone can also store up to 150 SMS or 50 picture messages. It comes with a 35 pre-loaded ring tones, the usual stopwatch, calculator, currency converter and four games—including a snow boarding game, reflecting the phones Finnish origin.

Features such as WAP 1.2.1 support, GPRS and HSCSD also make their way into this phone, not to mention the evergreen IrDA port. The inclusion of a mono FM radio into the set is a refreshing idea and makes it an ideal companion on the go.

The best feature is the awesome signal reception. This was the only phone that displayed full signal strength in our test, no matter where we placed it—due to which the speech quality was excellent.

The only bitter taste in this perfect concoction is its price—It is definitely not worth the price tag.

